NIT1203 Introduction to Project Management.

Block 3, Semester 2, Year 1 (2025)

Project:

NR & ReX Network Integration Project.

Group 03
Group Members:

- Kavish (s8173969)
- Darren (s8191228)
- Sarik (s8186539)

Table of Contents

Table of Contents 2
Project Charter 3
Appendix A – Group meeting minutes 8
Appendix A – Group meeting minutes (2nd Meeting) 9
Appendix B - Contribution Report 10
References 11

Project Charter

General Information		
Project Title		**Date**
NR & ReX Network Integration Project		05/10/2025
Project Manager	**Phone**	**Email**
Kavish Gunasekara	Given on request	S8173969@live.vu.edu.au
Executive Sponsor	**Phone**	**Email**
Ochini Madanayake	N/A	ochini.madanayake@vu.edu.au
Business Sponsor	**Phone**	**Email**
Michael Turner	N/A	michael.turner@nationalrailways.com.au
Document Version		**Updated Date**
1.0		05/10/2025

Project Scope (Situation / Problem / Opportunity)

Situation/Problem:

National Railways (R), the passenger provider and a leading freight company, has acquired Regional Express (ReX), a smaller last-mile delivery company. Currently, Rex and NR operate with different timetables, fleet equipment and scheduling software. These differences create operational inefficiencies, higher logistics costs, poor coordination and reduced customer satisfaction.

Opportunity:

The Network Integration Project seeks to harmonise both companies' operations. By unifying fleet management processes, deploying advanced tracking technologies and integrating scheduling systems. NR can reduce duplication, improve efficiency and strengthen internal communication. This will raise customer satisfaction. Enhance service delivery times and generate approximately $850,00 in annual savings over the next four years.

Project Goals

The Network Integration Project seeks to align ReX and NR operations while improving efficiency, customer satisfaction, technology adoption and financial performance.

1. Integration of Operations: Create a unified operational framework by standardising fleet management and scheduling through software and common procedures within 20 months.

2. Efficiency Improvement: Reduce duplication and Optimise routes to improve coordination across hubs, resulting in faster and more reliable services.

3. Technology Enhancement: Digital platforms and implement advanced tracking systems to provide real-time visibility and stronger communication between scheduling teams.

4. Customer Experience: Improve delivery times and digital transparency through the integration of both companies' platforms, leading to trust and higher customer satisfaction.

5. Financial Benefits: Achieve projected logistics cost savings of approximately $850,000 annually over four years through system integration and streamlined operations.

6. Organisational Growth: Strengthen long-term capability by embedding best practices, training staff and ensuring sustainable adoption of unified processes.

In Scope / Out of Scope

In Scope	Out of Scope
Standardising ReX and NR fleet management, tracking procedures and scheduling.	Purchase of vehicles, new trains or major infrastructure upgrades.
Integrating systems, digital platforms and databases.	Alterations to facilities or physical equipment.
Introducing advanced tracking technology for the real-time route optimisation.	Changes to customer pricing structures.
Retraining staff from both NR and ReX in unified processes, tracking tools and software.	Human Resource reforms such as contracts or salaries.
Improving internal communication across scheduling teams and depots.	Integration with international operations or other companies.
Pilot testing in selected hubs, followed by phased national rollout.	

Objectives / Success Criteria / Deliverables (if known)

Objectives

The project aims to integrate all ReX depots into NR's operational framework within the planned 20-month period. It will focus on improving delivery efficiency, deploying reliable tracking systems, ensuring staff are trained in the new unified platforms, and achieving projected logistics cost savings of approximately $850,000 annually as outlined in the assessment overview.

Success Criteria

Project success will be determined by the complete integration of ReX depots into NR's systems, improved delivery coordination, stable operation of tracking technologies, and successful completion of staff training programs. The achievement of the projected annual cost savings and positive feedback from pilot sites will indicate successful implementation.

Major Deliverables

Key deliverables include the approved Project Charter (Stage 1), a comprehensive Project Management Plan with Work Breakdown Structure, Gantt chart and cost baseline (Stage 2), integration architecture and data-migration packs, a unified tracking platform with updated Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs), staff training materials, a pilot-evaluation report, and a final rollout handover including maintenance and recovery procedures.

Acceptance Criteria

All deliverables will undergo review and sign off by the Project Manager and Executive Sponsor. Major milestones Charter, Design, Go-Live, and Closure require formal approval before progression. Successful user-acceptance testing confirmed staff adoption, and validation of the $850,000 annual cost savings by the project sponsors will constitute final acceptance.

Project Assumptions

The NR & ReX Network Integration Project is based on the following assumptions:

1. Budget Approval: Funding is released and approved on time.
2. Resource Availability: Skilled staff (PM, BA, Trainers, Engineers) will be available as scheduled.
3. Data Access: ReX and NR will provide timely access to operational data and systems.
4. Vendor Support: Technology vendors will supply reliable APIs, documentation and updates.
5. Stakeholder Cooperation: Managers and Staff will actively participate in adoption of new processes.
6. Regulatory Stability: No major changes in data compliance laws or transport.
7. Training Adoption: Staff will attend and complete training successfully.
8. No External Disruptions: The project will not face major delays from disasters, strikes or supply chain issues.

Risk and Dependencies

Key Risks	Key Dependencies
Integration Complexity: May cause delays/costs. Mitigated by phased rollout and early audits.	Timely fund release and budget approval.
Data Quality Issues: Risk of migration errors. Mitigated by validation, cleansing and pilot testing.	Skilled staff availability (PM, BA, Trainers, Engineers).
Cybersecurity Compliance: Fines or possible breaches. Mitigated by audits, security reviews and penetration testing.	API support and reliable vendor
Change Resistance: Staff may resist new systems. Addressed with champions, workshops and incentives.	Active stakeholder participation in UAT and training.
Vendor/API Delays: Late support can affect milestones. Managed with backup suppliers and SLAs.	Stable regulatory environment for data protection and transport.
Budget Overrun: Costs may exceed plan. Weekly monitoring and Controlling with a 10% buffer.	Continuous operation of ReX's legacy systems and NR's IT.
External Disruptions: Disasters, strikes, or regulation changes. Managed with timeline buffers and re-baselining.	

Resource Requirements

The NR & ReX Network Integration Project requires the following resources to deliver within the 20-month timeframe:

1. Facilities & Infrastructure The project will utilise meeting rooms, secure servers,laptops, VPN access, and backup systems to system integration and support team collaboration.
2. The project assumes the availability of skilled staff and timely budget approval. Vendor support is considered essential for contingency reserves to be in place and successful integrations to cover any unplanned expenses.

Human Resources	Technical Resources	Financial Resources
Project Manager: Oversees scope, cost, schedule and stakeholders.	Microsoft Project for Gantt charts and scheduling.	Personnel: ~45%
Business Analyst: Captures requirements and documents SOPs.	Collaboration tools (Teams/Zoom, SharePoint/Google Drive).	Vendor & Licenses: ~25%
Technical Team: Solution Architect, Data Engineers/Integration, QA/Testers.	Asana/Jira for issue tracking.	Change Management & Training: ~15%
Support Team: Change Manager, Trainers, Service Desk Lead, SMEs.	SharePoint/GitHub repositories and sandbox testing environments.	Contingency Reserve: ~15% (Detailed cost baseline to be provided in Stage 2.)
	Training platforms for staff adoption.	

Facilities & Infrastructure The project will utilise meeting rooms, secure servers,laptops, VPN access, and backup systems to system integration and support team collaboration.

The project assumes the availability of skilled staff and timely budget approval. Vendor support is considered essential for contingency reserves are in place and successful integrations to cover any unplanned expenses.

High-Level Milestones and Timeline

The NR & ReX Network Integration Project will run over 20 months, with the following key milestones:

Milestone	Description	Target Date
M1 Initiation	Charter approval, stakeholder identification	Month 1

M2 Requirements	Business/system analysis and gap review	Month 4
M3 Design	Integration architecture & security planning	Month 6
M4 Build & Migration	Configure systems, pilot data migration	Month 12
M5 Pilot	Deploy in selected depots, evaluate	Month 15
M6 Rollout	Full system rollout across depots	Month 19
M7 Closure	Final handover, lessons learned, sign-off	Month 20

Key milestone reviews at M1, M3, M5, and also M7 will require formal sponsor approval before proceeding to the next stage. The timeline also includes buffers to manage risks like data migration issues or vendor delays. A detailed Work Breakdown Structure (WBS) and Gantt chart will be developed in Stage 2 to expand on this high-level schedule.

Communication Strategy

Effective communication will ensure alignment between stakeholders, transparency and timely decision making, throughout the NR & ReX Network Integration Project.

Communication Objectives

1. Keep stakeholders informed of progress, and key decisions and risks.
2. Provide milestone updates to executive Sponsor and the Steering Committee.
3. Support collaboration across NR and ReX teams.
4. Maintain transparency through documented reporting.

Communication Matrix

Stakeholder	Information	Frequency	Channel	Owner
Executive Sponsor (Lecturer)	Charter, design, milestones, closure	At M1, M3, M5, M7	Reports & meetings	PM
Business Sponsor (NR COO)	Financial updates, ROI	Quarterly	Email, meetings	PM
Steering Committee	Risks, budget, decisions	Monthly	Meetings & Reports	PM
Project Team	Tasks, issues, dependencies	Weekly + ad hoc	Teams, email, Jira	PM
Depot & Scheduling Staff	Training & rollout updates	Pilot (M15), rollout (M19)	Email, Workshops,	Change Manager

End Users / Customers	Platform changes & Service updates	Go Live	Announcements, Portal	Communications Lead

Roles and Responsibilities				
Names	**Role**	**Position**	**Contact Information**	**Signature**
Ochini madanayake	Executive Sponsor	Unit Convenor, VU	ochini.madanayake@vu.edu.au	Ochini
NR COO	Business Sponsor	COO, National Railways	michael.turner@nationalrailways.com.au	Michael
Kavish Gunasekara	Project Manager	Team member	kavish.hettiarachchigedon@live.vu.edu.au	Kavish
Sarik	Business Analyst	Team member	sarik@live.vu.edu.au	Sarik
Darren	Technical Lead	Team member	darren@live.vu.edu.au	Darren
Change Manager (NR Staff)	Change & Training	NR Representative	rebecca.collins@nationalrailways.com.au	Rebecca
Comments (Handwritten or typed comments from above stakeholders, if applicable)				
"This project has the potential to significantly improve coordination cost efficiency and significantly improve coordination across NR and ReX operations." - Michael Turner "Change management and effective communication will be key to ensuring successful adoption in later stages." - Rebecca Collins				

Appendix A – Group meeting minutes

Meeting/Project Name:	Stage 1 – Project Charter (Network Integration project)		
Date of Meeting: (MM/DD/YYYY)	10/02/2025	Time:	1300 hours
Minutes Prepared By:	Darren Lim	Location:	Victoria University
1. Meeting Objective			
Identification of tasks, review of rubric and assignment of tasks between group members.			
2. Attendance at Meeting			
Name	Department/Division	E-mail	Phone
Darren Lim	Student	s8191228@live.vu.edu.au	Given on request
Kavish	Student	s8173969@live.vu.edu.au	Given on request

Sarik	Student	s8186539@live.vu.edu.au	Given on request

3. Agenda and Notes, Decisions, Issues		
Topic	Owner	Time
Volunteers to take the sections of: Project Scope, project goals and In-scope/ Out of scope within the project charter.	Darren Lim	1300 hours
Volunteers to take the sections of: Objectives / Success Criteria / Deliverables, project assumptions, risk and dependencies within the project charter.	Sarik	1330 hours
Volunteers to take the sections of: Resource requirements, high-level milestones and timeline, communication strategy within the project charter.	Kavish	1400 hours

4. Action Items		
Action	Owner	Due Date
Group agrees that Darren Lim will undertake the sections that he volunteered for.	Darren Lim	05/10/2025
Group agrees that Kavish will undertake the sections that he volunteered for.	Sarik	05/10/2025
Group agrees that Sarik will undertake the sections that he volunteered for.	Kavish	05/10/2025

5. Next Meeting (if applicable)					
Date (MM/DD/YYYY)	10/05/2025	Time:	1800 hours	Location:	Virtual Meeting on WhatApps
Objective:	Final review on progress of assigned sections and task of completing them.				

Appendix A – Group meeting minutes (2nd Meeting)

Meeting/Project Name:	Stage 1 – Project Charter (Network Integration project)		
Date of Meeting: (MM/DD/YYYY)	10/05/2025	Time:	1800 hours
Minutes Prepared By:	Darren Lim	Location:	Virtual Meeting

1. Meeting Objective
Review of rubric in comparison of overall progress on assignment of task between group members before agreeing on final submission.

2. Attendance at Meeting			
Name	Department/Division	E-mail	Phone
Darren Lim	Student	s8191228@live.vu.edu.au	Given on request

Kavish	Student	s8173969@live.vu.edu.au	Given on request
Sarik	Student	s8186539@live.vu.edu.au	Given on request

3. Agenda and Notes, Decisions, Issues

Topic	Owner	Time
Explanations of his progress on the sections of: Project Scope, project goals and In-scope/ Out-of scope within the project charter.	Darren Lim	1800 hours
Explainations of his progress on the sections of: Objectives / Success Criteria / Deliverables, project assumptions, risk and dependencies within the project charter.	Sarik	1830 hours
Explanations of his progress on the sections of: Resource requirements, high-level milestones and timeline, communication strategy within the project charter.	Kavish	1900 hours

4. Action Items

Action	Owner	Due Date
The group agrees that Darren Lim's sections is done to a good quality.	Darren Lim	05/10/2025
Group agrees that Sarik's sections are done to a good quality.	Sarik	05/10/2025
The group agrees that Kavish's sections are done to a good quality. The group agrees that Kavish will submit the project charter for review.	Kavish	05/10/2025

5. Next Meeting (if applicable)

Date :(MM/DD/YYYY)	N/A	Time:	N/A	Location:	N/A
Objective:	N/A				

Appendix B - Contribution Report

Student	Student Name	Contribution	Learnings	Contribution Percentage
s8191228	Darren Lim	Contributed to developing the Project Scope, Project Goals, and In Scope/Out of Scope sections. Analysed the assessment overview to identify the main operational issues between ReX and NR and structured them into a clear situation opportunity framework. Defined realistic goals aligned with project outcomes and ensured that the scope boundaries were consistent with the case study. Worked mainly through OneDrive discussions, and simplifying complex ideas into concise statements and reviewing draft wording.	Learned how to define a clear project scope and link it with measurable goals. Developed a better understanding of how scope boundaries prevent project overruns. Collaborative feedback from the team worked well, although limited meeting time occasionally affected real time discussion.	33.33%
s8186539	Sarik	Responsible for preparing the Objectives, Success Criteria, Deliverables, Project Assumptions, and Risks and Dependencies sections. Reviewed the assessment brief to ensure that objectives followed the SMART principle and reflected the expected $850 000 annual saving target. Refined risk identification by adding relevant mitigation strategies and dependencies based on the project scope. Contributed drafts via Word Online and participated in review sessions for feedback and improvement.	Learned the importance of aligning objectives with assessment rubrics and using measurable yet realistic criteria. Gained experience identifying risks and developing effective mitigation strategies. Collaboration through shared editing improved accuracy, although version control issues occasionally occurred.	33.33%
s8173969	Kavish Gunasekara	Led the preparation of Resource Requirements, High-Level Milestones and Timeline, and Communication Strategy sections, and coordinated the final editing of the Project Charter. Structured milestones into a 20-month schedule, organised the communication matrix, and ensured consistency across all sections. Proofread and formatted the document for clarity, tone, and alignment with the marking rubric prior to submission.	Learned to manage contributions from multiple team members and apply project management principles such as scheduling and resource allocation. Gained experience in document collaboration using Word Online and SharePoint. The clear division of tasks worked effectively.	33.33%

References

Atlassian. (2024). *Jira*. Atlassian.com. https://www.atlassian.com/software/jira

Elazar, E. (2018, April 23). *What is user acceptance testing (UAT) - the full process explained*.

Panaya.com. https://www.panaya.com/blog/testing/what-is-uat-testing/

Gantt. (2023). *What Is a Gantt Chart? Gantt Chart Software, Information, and History*. Gantt.com. https://www.gantt.com/

Gillingham, J. (2023, August 16). *What Is Microsoft Project? Overview, History & Features: a Beginner's Guide*. Invensislearning.com. https://www.invensislearning.com/blog/what-is-microsoft-project/

Holcombe, J. (2018, April 20). *What is github? a beginner's introduction to github*. Kinsta.com. https://kinsta.com/blog/what-is-github/

Microsoft. (2025). *Microsoft sharepoint | build your team intranet*. Microsoft.com. https://www.microsoft.com/en-au/microsoft-365/sharepoint/collaboration

Overby, S., Greiner, L., & Paul, L. G. (2024, June 21). *What is an SLA? Best practices for service-level agreements*. Cio.com. https://www.cio.com/article/274740/outsourcing-sla-definitions-and-solutions.html

Schneider, A. (2023, February 13). *Project sponsor: a look at the role and responsibilities*. Monday.com. https://monday.com/blog/project-management/project-sponsor/

University of California. (2016). *SMART Goals: a How to Guide*. University of California. https://www.ucop.edu/local-human-resources/_files/performance-appraisal/How+to+write+SMART+Goals+v2.pdf

Work Breakdown Structure. (2025). *What is a work breakdown structure*. Workbreakdownstructure.com. https://www.workbreakdownstructure.com/